of Kao as the Senior Advisor to Indira Gandhi in the Cabinet Secretariat did not have the brilliant dazzle of his tenure as the founder and head of the R&AW between 1968 and 1977.' [13]

The hard-working B. Raman

B. (Bahukutumbi) Raman (IPS 1961 Madhya Pradesh) represented the third category of officers mentioned at the beginning of this chapter. Raman was one of the most hard-working officers to have been employed at the R&AW. A bachelor, he was married to his work and had no other hobby. For him, his home was an extension of his office. He could rattle off facts and figures on the subjects he dealt with at will. He had all the qualities that a R&AW chief needed in his staff officer, and this endeared him to Kao also. But in his handling of Sikh affairs up to the period ending November 1984 and thereafter, he suffered the following handicaps:

First, as Sikh extremism was totally a new development for the R&AW till the end of 1980, there were no past records of such activities in the Department to consult or refer to. Some files on the activities (from within Pakistan and the UK and US) of the Pakistan-sponsored Jagjit Singh Chauhan's organization and the related activities of people like Ganga Singh Dhillon of Nankana Sahib Foundation in Washington DC might have been transferred from the R&AW's Pakistan division to the newly created division under Raman. It was natural that the R&AW officers already posted in areas (before the seven new stations started functioning one by one by early 1982) where there was a comparatively large presence of Sikhs, after being asked to watch out for pro-Khalistan or Sikh extremist activities, might have started sending their reports on the subject. But those would have been sketchy to begin with. So, Raman's information bank was initially mainly based on published information and the sketchy reports from existing stations based on the new charter of requirements.

Second, Raman did not go deep into the recent or early history of the Sikhs to really appreciate why the concept of Khalistan started attracting attention of some only after the Congress returned to power in January 1980. This lack of proper understanding of the